

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for guitar and three voices. The guitar part is in the key of D major (indicated by two sharps) and 3/4 time. It features a series of chords with fingerings: E (1 4 2), F#m (2 1 3), B (3 2 1 1), E (1 4 2), E (1 4 2), A (2 1), Bsus (2 3 1 1), B (3 2 1 1), E (1 4 2), A (2 1), F#m (2 1 3), G# (4 1 3 2), E/G# (x x o x), G#m (1 3 4 2), F#m (2 1 3), B (3 2 1 1), and E (1 4 2). The three vocal parts are in the same key and time. The lyrics are as follows:

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.